

EC4007

Fundamentals of Economics

Term(s): SEMB

International Study Centre

MODULE GUIDE 2025/26



University of
East London

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The Module Leader/Other Tutors and Contact Details were correct at point of publication.
You will be notified of any changes.

Module Introduction



Welcome to the Fundamentals of Economics – EC4007 module!

This guide is an introduction to the module and includes important information. Make sure you have this document downloaded and stored in your computer/laptop. If you're not sure about something, please ask us.

The International Study Centre (ISC) team will keep you informed of any changes. This will be via your UEL email account, so it is extremely important that you check your email account daily to avoid missing an important email. Key information and the course and assessment materials will be posted on Moodle. You can access Moodle using this link: [Home | Moodle Home](#)

The lessons will be delivered face to face and on campus. You are expected to participate and to take notes. There will be class, group and pair discussions and you are expected to interact in a respectful way with your fellow students and lecturer. All materials will be posted on Moodle so that if you miss a lesson, you are able to see the materials at home. You will submit your assignments on Moodle via Turnitin apart from time-constrained assessments.

You must attend on time to your classes out of respect for the lecturer and the other students. It is expected that you will attend 100% of this module. This is to achieve the best possible result for your work. Also, you will gain much more from the course if you commit 100% to it.

Furthermore, as a condition of your Student Route visa your attendance **must be at least 85%** or you will be in breach of your visa conditions and the UK Home Office may be informed.

You can find the Module Specification document on Moodle page for this module: [Edit course: EC4007 2526 \(T2\) Fundamentals of Economics \(MH\) \(OC\) | Moodle Home](#)

Module Aims and Learning Outcomes

Aims:

- To develop your understanding of core economic concepts, theories, institutions and the wider economic environment, enabling you to recognise how national and global economic structures and government policies influence business organisations.

- To develop your ability to apply economic tools, evaluate theories, and analyse qualitative and quantitative data so that you can assess business performance, interpret policy outcomes, and make informed decision about the UK and global economies.
- To help you to understand the impact of economic functions in a market which are necessary for you to run the business effectively.

Learning Outcomes:

1. Demonstrate understanding of the assumptions, logical structure, implications and limitations of core economic concepts, theories and ideas.
2. Demonstrate knowledge regarding the nature and development of key economic (and economics-related) institutions and socio-economic structures affecting the operation of business and non-business organisations, national economies, the global economy and government.
3. Critically evaluate the relevance of diverse theories and concepts and evaluate the relationship between economic theory, the broader institutional context, and government policies.
4. Apply economic theories and tools to the analysis of business and non-business organisations, national and global financial structures and public policy and discuss, analyse and evaluate government policy and to assess the performance of the UK and other economies and of the global economy.
5. Gather evidence and assimilate, structure, analyse and evaluate qualitative and quantitative data and draw economic policy inferences, recognize the potential constraints in their implementation and to evaluate policy outcomes in the light of stated policy objectives.

Key Information



- This is a core module.
- There are no pre-requisites for this module.
- Your sessions will be divided into lectures, seminars, and workshops.
- There are pre-class activities you need to engage with before you come to your taught session.

Link to Apprenticeship

This module is not delivered on an apprenticeship.

Teaching Schedule

Week 1: (W/C 26/01/2026) – Introduction to Module & Economic Thinking

- **Time:** See your individual Timetable
- **Aim:** To introduce students to the purpose and scope of economics and explain how economic thinking supports business and public policy decisions. To familiarise students with the module structure, learning outcomes, assessment requirements, and expectations for academic engagement.
- **Learning Objectives**
 1. Explain what economics is and why it is relevant to real-world business and policy contexts.
 2. Distinguish between microeconomics and macroeconomics using clear, applied examples.
 3. Identify the structure and expectations of the portfolio assessment.
- **Prepare**
 - Watch an introductory video that explains the core ideas of economics, including scarcity, choice, and opportunity cost.
<https://youtu.be/dVTNmSmUo14>
- **Lecture**
 - Explain the meaning and scope of economics and its role in understanding decision-making by households, firms, and governments.
 - Introduce the concept of scarcity and discuss why choices always involve trade-offs.
 - Distinguish clearly between microeconomics and macroeconomics, using current business and policy examples.
 - Outline the module structure, learning outcomes, assessment format, submission requirements, and expectations regarding academic integrity and responsible AI use.
- **Seminar**
 - Analyse current news headlines to identify underlying economic issues.
 - Classify each issue as microeconomic or macroeconomic and justify the classification.

- Discuss answers in small groups to build confidence in economic terminology and reasoning.
- **Workshop**
 - Introduce the assessment and the portfolio expectations.
 - Explain how weekly topics will directly support different sections of the portfolio.
- **Consolidate**
 - Complete an interactive H5P quiz to reinforce key concepts introduced in the week.
 - Write a short reflective post explaining how economic thinking can be applied to everyday decisions.
 -
- **Resources**
 - Mankiw, N.G., Taylor, P.M. and Ashwin, A. (2019) *Business Economics*. 3rd edn. Cengage Learning. Chapter 1:
 - Office for National Statistics (ONS) – UK economic overview

Week 2: (W/C 02/02/2026) – The Economic Environment and Scarcity

- **Time:** See your individual Timetable
- **Aim:** To develop an understanding of scarcity, opportunity cost, and resource allocation in economic decision-making.
- **Learning Objectives**
 1. Explain the concept of scarcity and why it underpins all economic decisions.
 2. Define opportunity cost and apply it to real-world examples.
 3. Apply the Production Possibility Frontier (PPF) to illustrate trade-offs and efficiency.
- **Prepare**
 - Watch a video explaining scarcity and opportunity cost
<https://youtu.be/12ZINwgxsOI>
- **Lecture**
 - Explain scarcity as the fundamental economic problem faced by all societies.
 - Discuss opportunity cost as the value of the next best alternative forgone.
 - Introduce economic agents (households, firms, governments) and explain their different roles.
- **Seminar**
 - Group activity where students participate in a resource allocation simulation that highlights the effects of scarcity.

- Compare how different economic agents prioritise resources under constraints.
- Discuss how opportunity cost differs depending on perspective.
- **Workshop**
 - Apply scarcity and opportunity cost concepts to Greggs' expansion strategy (e.g. labour shortages, energy prices).
 - Draft a short analytical paragraph suitable for inclusion in the portfolio.
- **Consolidate**
 - Complete H5P quiz testing understanding of opportunity cost analysis.
 - Write a reflective journal entry on how scarcity influences decision-making.
- **Resources**
 - Mankiw, N.G. et al. (2019) *Business Economics*. Chapter 2
 - ONS: Productivity and economic growth data
 - World Bank: World Development Indicators

Week 3: (W/C 09/02/2026) – The Market System: Demand and Supply

- **Time:** See your individual Timetable
- **Aim:** To explain how markets allocate resources through prices and respond to changes in economic conditions.
- **Learning Objectives**
 1. Draw and interpret demand and supply curves.
 2. Analyse how changes in demand or supply affect market equilibrium.
 3. Explain how markets adjust following external shocks.
- **Prepare**
 - Watch a video explaining how prices are determined in competitive markets. <https://youtu.be/1XIG6Lo5cjq>
- **Lecture**
 - Explain how demand and supply curves are constructed and interpreted.
 - Discuss the key factors that cause shifts in demand and supply.
 - Analyse how equilibrium prices and quantities are determined.
 - Illustrate how real-world shocks affect prices using food and retail market examples.
- **Seminar**
 - Analyse a real-world food market case study in small groups.
 - Practise drawing and interpreting demand and supply diagrams.
- **Workshop**

- Apply demand and supply analysis to Greggs' products and market conditions.
- Produce a draft demand and supply diagram for the portfolio.
- **Consolidate**
 - Complete an interactive H5P quiz focused on demand and supply analysis.
- **Resources**
 - Mankiw, N.G. et al. (2019) *Business Economics*. Chapter 4 and 5
 - ONS :Consumer price data
 - World Bank: World Development Indicators

Week 4: (W/C 16/02/2026) – Market Failure and Government Intervention

- **Time:** See your individual Timetable
- **Aim:** To examine why markets may fail and assess the role of government intervention.
- **Learning Objectives**
 1. Identify different types of market failure.
 2. Explain the rationale for government intervention.
 3. Evaluate the effectiveness and limitations of policy responses.
- **Prepare**
 - Watch an explainer video introducing market failure concepts.
<https://youtu.be/13JOGWzY8kE>
<https://youtu.be/a9yO-K8mwL0>
- **Lecture**
 - Explain what market failure is and why free markets may not always be efficient.
 - Discuss externalities, public goods, and information asymmetry.
 - Evaluate policy tools such as taxation, subsidies, and regulation.
- **Seminar**
 - Group debate real-world policy examples such as sugar taxes or energy price caps.
 - Watch: <https://youtu.be/Uvzfbt52yGQ>
 - Assess the benefits and drawbacks of intervention in each case.
- **Workshop**
 - Identify government policies relevant to Greggs (e.g. VAT rules, labour regulation, energy support).
 - Practise selecting and referencing credible economic data sources.

- Begin drafting policy analysis for the portfolio.
- **Consolidate**
 - Complete a matching activity linking market failures to policy tools.
 - Write a reflective post evaluating the effectiveness of a chosen policy.

Resources

- Barr, N. (2012) *Economics of the Welfare State*. Oxford University Press. Selected chapters.
- [UK Government: Energy and tax policy announcements](#)

Week 5: (W/C 23/02/2026) – Elasticity and Business Pricing

- **Time:** See your individual Timetable
- **Aim:** To analyse how responsiveness to price changes influences business pricing decisions.
- **Learning Objectives**
 1. Calculate and interpret price elasticity of demand.
 2. Classify products as elastic or inelastic.
 3. Apply elasticity concepts to business pricing strategies.
- **Prepare**
 - Watch a video demonstrating elasticity in real markets.
<https://youtu.be/1XXhpHJTglg>
- **Lecture**
 - Explain price elasticity of demand and its interpretation.
 - Demonstrate how elasticity affects total revenue.
 - Discuss factors influencing elasticity.
 - Apply elasticity to business pricing examples in retail markets.
- **Seminar**
 - Students to apply elasticity of everyday products.
 - Evaluate pricing scenarios and predict revenue outcomes.
- **Workshop**
 - Apply elasticity analysis to Greggs' pricing strategy.
 - Produce a draft elasticity diagram for the portfolio.
 - Receive formative feedback on analytical clarity.
- **Consolidate**
 - Write a short reflection on price elasticity

- **Resources**
 - **Consumer trends, UK - Office for National Statistics**

Week 6: (W/C 02/03/2026) – Firms and Market Structures

- **Time:** See your individual Timetable
- **Aim:** To examine how firms operate under different market structures and how cost conditions influence pricing, output, and competition.
- **Learning Objectives**
 1. Distinguish between the main market structures (perfect competition, monopoly, oligopoly, monopolistic competition).
 2. Explain the role of costs, revenues, and economies of scale in firm decision-making.
 3. Analyse how market structure affects pricing behaviour, innovation, and consumer choice.
- **Prepare**
 - Watch video introducing different market structures and their key characteristics. <https://youtu.be/u1xIZOieOUw>
- **Lecture**
 - Explain the objectives of firms, including profit maximisation and survival.
 - Introduce key cost concepts, including fixed costs, variable costs, average costs, and marginal costs.
 - Discuss economies and diseconomies of scale and their implications for firm growth.
 - Analyse the defining features of different market structures and compare their outcomes for prices, output, and efficiency.
- **Seminar**
 - Analyse case examples from the UK food-to-go and retail sector.
 - Identify the market structure in which Greggs operates and justify the classification.
 - Discuss how competition affects pricing and product differentiation.
- **Workshop**
 - Draft the market structure analysis section of the Greggs portfolio.
 - Apply theory to explain Greggs' pricing power and competitive environment.
- **Consolidate**
 - Write a short comparison paragraph contrasting two market structures.
- **Resources**
 - Mankiw, N.G., Taylor, P.M. and Ashwin, A. (2019) *Business Economics*. 3rd edn. Cengage. Ch. 6–7.

- Sloman, J. and Garratt, D. (2016) *Essentials of Economics*. Pearson.
- Competition and Markets Authority - GOV.UK
- Greggs plc Annual Report – Business model and competition overview.

Week 7: (W/C 09/03/2026) – Factor Markets (Labour, Capital, Land)

- **Time:** See your individual Timetable
- **Aim:** To analyse how factor markets operate and how changes in labour and input costs influence business decisions.
- **Learning Objectives**
 1. Explain how labour, capital, and land markets function.
 2. Analyse wage determination and labour market dynamics.
 3. Evaluate the impact of factor market conditions on business costs and expansion decisions.
- **Prepare**
 - Read a short summary of UK labour market trends using ONS data. And UK Labour Market February 2025 - GOV.UK
 - Watch an introductory video explaining labour demand, labour supply, and wage determination. <https://youtu.be/PIHLpv3jyTg>
- **Lecture**
 - Explain the concept of factor markets and how factors of production are rewarded.
 - Discuss labour demand and supply and how wages are determined in competitive markets.
 - Analyse the impact of minimum wage policies, labour shortages, and productivity changes.
 - Evaluate how changes in labour and input markets affect firms' production costs and profitability.
- **Seminar**
 - Analyse recent UK labour market data, focusing on wages, vacancies, and employment. UK Labour Market February 2025 - GOV.UK and labour market trends using ONS data.
 - Discuss labour shortages and wage pressures in the retail and food sectors.
 - Evaluate how firms respond to rising labour and input costs.
- **Workshop**
 - Apply labour market and input cost analysis to Greggs' expansion strategy.

- Construct a factor market table for inclusion in the portfolio.
- Write a reflective paragraph identifying which factor market poses the greatest risk to Greggs and why.
- **Consolidate**
 - Write a reflective paragraph identifying which factor market poses the greatest risk to Greggs and why.
- **Resources**
 - Office for National Statistics (ONS) – Labour Market Overview.
 - Minimum Wage and labour market.
 - ILO Homepage | International Labour Organization

Week 8: (W/C 16/03/2026) – Environmental Analysis: PESTLE

- **Time:** See your individual Timetable
- **Aim:** To assess the external business environment using the PESTLE framework.
- **Learning Objectives**
 1. Explain the purpose and components of the PESTLE framework.
 2. Apply PESTLE analysis to a real business context.
 3. Evaluate how external factors influence strategic business decisions.
- **Prepare**
 - Watch a video explaining the PESTLE framework and its use in business analysis. <https://youtu.be/bYn4CyL3r5w>
- **Lecture**
 - Explain the structure and purpose of the PESTLE framework.
 - Discuss political, economic, social, technological, legal, and environmental factors in detail.
 - Analyse how changes in the external environment create risks and opportunities for businesses.
 - Demonstrate the application of PESTLE using a UK retail case study.
- **Seminar**
 - Work in small groups to identify key PESTLE factors affecting organisation.
 - Discuss which external factors are likely to have the greatest impact on business performance.
 - Compare findings across groups to build a comprehensive analysis.
- **Workshop**
 - Construct a PESTLE analysis for Greggs for inclusion in the portfolio.

- Discuss how PESTLE links to earlier topics such as macroeconomic policy and labour markets.
- **Consolidate**
 - Write a reflective analysis explaining which PESTLE factor is most significant and why.
- **Resources**
 - De Sousa, G.C. and Castañeda-Ayarza, J.A., 2022. PESTEL analysis and the macro-environmental factors that influence the development of the electric and hybrid vehicles industry in Brazil. *Case Studies on Transport Policy*, 10(1), pp.686-699. Office for National Statistics (ONS) – Economic indicators.
 - World Bank Group - International Development, Poverty and Sustainability

Week 9: (W/C 23/03/2026) – Macroeconomic Goals and Policy Tools/ Formative submission

- **Time:** See your individual Timetable
- **Aim:** To understand macroeconomic objectives and evaluate government policy tools.
- **Learning Objectives**
 1. Explain key macroeconomic goals such as growth, low inflation, and employment.
 2. Interpret macroeconomic indicators including GDP, inflation, and unemployment.
 3. Evaluate the effectiveness of fiscal and monetary policy tools.
- **Prepare**
 - Explore the ONS macroeconomic dashboard to familiarise yourself with current UK data. Understanding the UK economy
 - Read a short summary of recent UK fiscal and monetary policy decisions. Monetary policy | Bank of England
- **Lecture**
 - Explain the main macroeconomic objectives of governments.
 - Introduce key indicators used to measure economic performance.
 - Discuss fiscal policy tools, including taxation and government spending.
 - Analyse monetary policy tools, including interest rates and quantitative easing.
 - Evaluate the strengths and limitations of macroeconomic policy responses.
- **Seminar**
 - Analyse macroeconomic data for the UK or an assigned country.

- Discuss how macroeconomic conditions affect households and businesses.
- Evaluate recent policy decisions and their likely economic impact
- **Workshop**
 - Submit a formative draft of the portfolio for feedback.
 - Receive structured feedback on economic analysis, use of data, diagrams, and written communication.
 - Identify clear actions for improvement before final submission.
- **Consolidate**
 - Write a reflective report on the most pressing macroeconomic challenge facing the UK economy.
- **Resources**
 - Bank of England: Monetary Policy Reports.
 - Office for National Statistics (ONS) – GDP, inflation, labour market data.

Week 10: (W/C 30/03/2026) – Global Economics and Trade

- **Time:** See your individual Timetable
- **Aim:** To explore how international trade and global economic conditions influence businesses and national economies.
- **Learning Objectives**
 1. Explain the theory of comparative and absolute advantage.
 2. Analyse the effects of trade barriers and exchange rate movements.
 3. Evaluate how global economic conditions affect UK businesses.
- **Prepare**
 - Watch a video explaining comparative advantage and international trade.

<https://youtu.be/ol4NexZ0iI>
- **Lecture**
 - Explain the principles of comparative and absolute advantage.
 - Discuss the benefits and costs of international trade and globalisation.
 - Analyse the role of trade barriers such as tariffs and quotas.
 - Evaluate how exchange rate movements affect competitiveness and profitability.
- **Seminar**
 - Analyse US-China trade disputes and UK trade relationships.

- Discuss the impact of global economic conditions on UK firms in the food and retail sector.
- **Workshop**
 - Integrate global trade and external economic analysis into the Greggs portfolio.
 - Draft an evidence-based final recommendation on Greggs' expansion strategy.
 - Receive tutor guidance on synthesis, structure, and evaluation.
- **Consolidate**
 - Complete a short writing task refining the portfolio conclusion.
 - Reflect on how global economics shapes business decision-making.

Resources

- World Trade Organization (WTO) – Trade statistics and case studies.
- Krugman, P., Obstfeld, M. and Melitz, M. (2018) *International Economics*. Pearson.
- World Bank – Global economic indicators.

Week 11: (W/C 13/04/2026) Revision & Assessment Support

- **Time:** See your individual Timetable
- **Aim:** Consolidate learning from all topics, refine academic writing skills, and prepare a professional, well-structured financial analysis report.
- **Prepare:**
 - Proofread your report and follow Cite Them Right Online UEL - Referencing Information
- **Lecture:** Revision and structure/academic style for reports review.
- **Seminar:** Feedback: recommendation justifications
- **Workshop:** Final editing and Q&A; upload of file
- **Consolidate:** Checklist self-review: accuracy, coherence, citations

Resources:

- Proofread your report and follow Cite Them Right Online UEL - Referencing Information

Week 12: (W/C 20/4/2026)- Final Submission Week

Aim: Submit a complete applied economics portfolio demonstrating your ability to analyse real-world economic conditions, interpret data, apply economic theory, and make evidence-based decision within a business context.

More information

- [Link to your **personal timetable**](#) (UEL login required)
 - [**Link to the Docklands Campus Map**](#)
 - [**Link to the Stratford Campus Map**](#)
 - [**Link to University Square Stratford**](#)
 - [**Guide to Room Numbers**](#)

Engagement and Attendance Requirements

Evidence shows that good attendance has a positive impact on academic performance. As a university, we are committed to supporting you in reaching your full potential.

[Student Engagement, Retention and Success Unit \(SERT\)](#) is here to support you in reaching your full potential. By monitoring attendance and engagement, we can identify early signs that you may need support and work with you to address any challenges that could be affecting your learning.

If you are experiencing challenges that impact your ability to engage with your course, you can speak to a member of the team in person at either the Docklands or Stratford campus, or remotely by telephone. To book an appointment or ask a question, please use [MyPortal](#) or call The Hub on 0208 223 4444 to speak with our Duty Advisor (available weekdays, 10am-1pm, excluding bank holidays).

Assessment Information

Assessment Overview:

This module is assessed through a single, comprehensive portfolio designed to develop your understanding of fundamental economic concepts and strengthen your ability to apply economic theory to real-world business situations. The portfolio encourages you to analyse contemporary economic conditions, interpret data, construct economic arguments, and make informed decision skills essential for studying economics and for future professional decision-making. You will work with a real business scenario and use economic models, diagrams, graphs, and UK data sources to evaluate how firms operate within changing microeconomic and macroeconomic environments. Throughout the portfolio, you will demonstrate analytical thinking, evidence-based reasoning, and reflective learning in line with the module's learning outcomes.

Scenario: Economic Evaluation of Greggs plc's Expansion Strategy in the UK

Gregg's plc, of the UK's leading bakery and food-on-the-go retailer, has continued to expand rapidly since the pandemic, investing in new store openings, drive-thru formats, automation, and partnerships with major retailers such as Tesco, Sainsbury's, and Primark. The company's strategy emphasises accessibility, low prices, and high-volume production supported by a vertically integrated supply chain. Despite strong brand recognition and rising market share, Greggs now operates in a challenging economic climate marked by increase inflation, volatile energy and wheat prices, rising interest rates, and falling real household incomes.

At the same time, labour shortages, wage pressures, and supply chain disruptions have increased operational uncertainty. Greggs' leadership team must decide whether continuing aggressive expansion is economically viable in this environment. You have been appointed as a junior economic analyst to prepare a portfolio of evidence-based economic analysis, using real UK data and economic models, to advise whether Greggs should maintain, slow down, or adjust its expansion strategy.

Requirements

You are to produce a 2,500-word analytical portfolio, supported by graphs, charts, tables, and diagrams that you create yourself using credible data sources (ONS, Bank of England, HM Treasury, etc.). Each portfolio part includes required evidence and a short reflective element to demonstrate your understanding of economic reasoning.

Your work must:

- Apply relevant economic theories, concepts, and models
- Use at least four original graphs or charts across the portfolio
- Include at least one economic diagram (elasticity, cost curves, or market structure)
- Show your own data selection process and interpretation
- Provide a final economic recommendation supported by evidence

Portfolio Structure

Part 1: Economic & Business Environment Analysis

Tasks

1. Summarise Greggs' business model and UK expansion strategy.

2. Conduct a targeted UK PESTLE analysis focusing on inflation, interest rates, wage trends, energy prices, and consumer/ business confidence.
3. Explain how these conditions affect Greggs' costs and demand using economic reasoning.

Required Evidence

- **A PESTLE table**
- **At least two graphs or chart** based on UK macroeconomic data (e.g., CPI, interest rates, consumer confidence)
- **Reflection:** Which economic pressures matter most, and why?

Part 2: Microeconomic Analysis: Demand, Competition, Pricing

Tasks

1. Identify and justify the market structure where Greggs operates.
2. Apply microeconomic concepts:
 - Price elasticity of demand
 - Competitive rivalry (Pret, Costa, supermarkets)
 - Greggs' value-based pricing strategy
3. Include a labelled microeconomic diagram (elasticity, cost curves, or monopolistic competition).

Required Evidence

- One economic diagram
- One competitor mapping chart or table
- Reflection: How effectively does microeconomic theory explain Greggs' pricing behaviour?

Part 3: Factor Market Evaluation

Tasks

1. Analyse UK labour market conditions affecting Greggs (National Living Wage (NLW) increases, vacancies, shortages).
2. Evaluate input markets (wheat prices, energy costs, supply chain conditions).
3. Explain how factor market risks influence expansion decisions.

Required Evidence

- One table comparing key labour and input indicators
- At least one graph or chart on wages, wheat prices, or energy indices

- Reflection: Which factor markets create the greatest expansion risk?

Part 4: Macroeconomic Policy and Expansion Feasibility

Tasks

1. Compare UK macro indicators (CPI, wage growth, interest rates, GDP).
2. Evaluate effects of government policies such as but not limited to:
 - Energy Price Guarantee
 - National Living Wage
 - VAT rules on food
3. Assess whether Greggs' expansion strategy is economically justifiable.
4. Provide a final evidence-based economic recommendation.

Required Evidence

- One macroeconomic chart created from your dataset
- A decision weighing benefits and risks of expansion
- Reflection: How do macroeconomic changes influence Greggs' 2–3-year growth prospects?

Part 5: Final Reflection & Conclusion

Tasks

Reflect on:

- Which economic theories most helped your analysis
- Limitations and assumptions
- How your understanding of applied economics has developed through using real data, models, and policy evaluation

Suggested Sources

- **Office for National Statistics (ONS): UK Economic Indicators**
Inflation (CPI), labour market statistics, GDP, wages, consumer confidence.
- **Bank of England: Monetary Policy & Economic Data**
Interest rates, inflation reports, economic forecasts.
- **HM Treasury: Government Policy & Fiscal Analysis**
National Living Wage documents, Energy Price Guarantee, fiscal statements.
- **Statista: Industry & Consumer Data**

Retail, bakery market statistics, consumer spending trends.

- **British Retail Consortium (BRC): Retail Trends**
Retail price index, supply chain issues, labour market impacts.
- **Kantar Retail Insights: UK Food & Grocery Trends**
Market share data, food-to-go insights, consumer behaviour summaries.
- **Greggs plc Annual Reports & Investor Presentations**
Financial performance, pricing strategy, expansion plans, supply chain operations.
- **Food Standards Agency (FSA) : Food Industry & Supply Chain Information**
Food supply chain resilience, regulatory updates.
- **Trading Economics: Global and UK Commodity Prices**
Wheat prices, energy indices, global commodity trends relevant to factor markets.
- **Institute for Fiscal Studies (IFS): Economic Commentary**
Cost-of-living analysis, real income changes, labour market insights.
- **World Bank: Global Economic Indicators & Commodity Data**
Useful for understanding global wheat markets, supply shocks, and international inflation pressures influencing UK bakery costs.
- **Euromonitor: Global & UK Retail and Foodservice Market Analysis**
Industry reports on foodservice, market structure, competitive landscape, consumer trends.

Submission Format:

The submission is in the form of an individual written report via Turnitin on the course Moodle page. This should be written in a concise, formal business style using single spacing and font size 12. You are required to make use of headings, paragraphs and subsections as appropriate, and all work must be supported with research and referenced using the Harvard referencing style. The recommended word limit for the task is 2,500 words +/- (-) 10%. (excluding references)

The report must follow a clear structure, use academic referencing (Harvard style), and be submitted by the published deadline in **Week 12**.

Weighting: 100%

Due Date and Time:

Date: 20/04/2026

Time: by 12 Noon

Learning outcomes assessed:

LO1, LO2, LO3, LO4, LO5.

Formative Tasks and Submissions:

Formative tasks are designed to give you regular practice and feedback so that you can build your skills and confidence before the graded assessments. While formative work does not carry marks, it is an essential part of your learning process.

Weekly Formative Tasks (Weeks 2–8)

In each workshop, you will complete short in-class activities linked to the week's economic focus.

These include:

- Constructing supply and demand diagrams for different market scenarios
- Identifying and interpreting key UK economic indicators (CPI, GDP, wage growth, interest rates)
- Analysing elasticity using real or simulated data
- Completing short PESTLE exercises for business environment analysis
- Working in Excel to create economic charts (inflation trends, labour market data, commodity prices)

All tasks will be supported by tutor guidance and discussion. These sessions are designed to build your confidence with economic tools, models, and data, and prepare you for completing each section of the portfolio.

Draft Portfolio Submission (Week 9) 27/3/2026 by 12noon

You will submit a draft portfolio covering:

- PESTLE table and initial macroeconomic graph
- Draft microeconomic diagram (e.g., elasticity or market structure)
- Early analysis of competition, pricing, or factor markets
- Initial data tables (inflation, wages, input prices)
- Preliminary reflections on how economic theory supports your analysis

This draft will receive formative feedback to help you refine your final 2,500-word applied economics portfolio.

You will receive written and/or verbal feedback on your draft. This feedback is designed to help you refine your work before the **final submission**.

Why Formative Work Matters

- Gives you **low-stakes practice** applying economic theories, models, and tools before the final portfolio.
- Provides **feedback loops** at multiple points in the term (Weeks 1–6 and Week 9) to improve your understanding.
- Helps you strengthen your data interpretation, diagram creation, and analytical accuracy before final grading.
- Builds confidence in using economics to evaluate real-world business environments and make evidence-based judgments.

Assessment criteria:

Weight	Band E (39% or Lower)	Band D (40–59%)	Band C (60–69%)	Band B (70-79%)	Band A (80% or Higher)
Criterion					
Understanding of Core Economic Concepts & Theories 20%	Demonstrates limited understanding of core economic concepts and theories. Explanations contain significant inaccuracies or misconceptions that limit meaningful application.	Demonstrates basic understanding of core concepts and theories. Explanations are generally correct but remain descriptive and lack depth or clarity.	Demonstrates competent understanding of key economic concepts and theories. Explanations are mostly accurate, though depth or precision may vary.	Demonstrates strong understanding of economic concepts and theories. Explanations are accurate, clear, and appropriately applied to the context.	Demonstrates excellent and confident understanding of economic concepts and theories, including assumptions and limitations, applied accurately and insightfully.
Application of Economic Models, Diagrams & Tools 20%	Use of economic models, diagrams, or tools is limited or inaccurate. Diagrams or calculations contain errors that reduce their usefulness.	Economic models and diagrams are used at a basic level. Some accuracy is evident, though labelling, explanation, or application is underdeveloped.	Economic models, diagrams, and tools are applied competently and mostly accurately. Explanations support understanding, though integration may be uneven.	Economic models, diagrams, and tools are applied accurately and clearly. Diagrams are well-labelled and effectively support the analysis.	Economic models, diagrams, and analytical tools are applied accurately, confidently, and effectively, demonstrating strong analytical control and clarity.
Economic Analysis & Evaluation of Business and Policy Contexts 25%	Analysis is largely descriptive, with limited evaluation of business conditions or policy impacts. Contextual links are insufficient.	Provides basic analysis of business or policy contexts. Some evaluation is evident, though reasoning is limited and largely descriptive.	Provides sound analysis of business and policy contexts, with relevant evaluation. Links between theory, data, and context are present but not fully developed.	Provides clear and well-developed analysis of business and policy contexts. Evaluation demonstrates good understanding of economic implications.	Provides insightful and comprehensive economic analysis, critically evaluating business and policy contexts with strong integration of theory, data, and evidence.
Presentation and Interpretation of Economic Data 20%	Use of data is minimal or inappropriate. Interpretation is limited, and charts or tables do not effectively support analysis.	Uses data at a basic level. Some interpretation is evident, though presentation or explanation may be unclear or incomplete.	Uses relevant qualitative and quantitative data competently. Interpretation is generally sound, though depth or clarity may vary.	Uses and interprets economic data effectively. Charts, tables, and graphs are clear, accurate, and well integrated into the analysis.	Uses a wide range of relevant economic data effectively and critically. Data selection, interpretation, and presentation strongly support the analysis.
Professional Communication, Structure & Referencing 15%	Structure and academic communication are insufficient. Arguments are unclear, and referencing is inconsistent or largely absent.	Demonstrates basic structure and communication. Writing is generally understandable, though organisation and referencing are inconsistent.	Demonstrates clear structure and appropriate academic style. Referencing is present and generally accurate, with minor inconsistencies.	Demonstrates professional academic communication. Structure is clear, arguments are coherent, and referencing is mostly accurate and consistent.	Demonstrates a high standard of professional academic communication. Structure is coherent throughout, writing is clear and precise, and referencing is accurate and consistently applied.

How to submit your work:

All submissions for this component(s) of this Module must be submitted according to these instructions. If you fail to submit this component as directed, a mark of 0 will be awarded for the component.

All work must be submitted on Moodle, via a Turnitin submission link that you will find in the Moodle page for this module under the 'Assessment and Feedback Tab'.

Note: Always ensure that your submitted work adheres to the university's plagiarism and academic integrity policies. Remember to keep a backup of all your submitted work, and it's advised to retain email confirmations of any electronic submissions.

Return of your work:

The work will be returned to you in two ways:

1. Moodle feedback: once the work has been marked and moderated, you will be able to see your provisional results on UEL Direct and your feedback on Moodle.
2. After the assessment board has reviewed the submissions, your results will be officially published by the University, and you will be able to see them in UEL Direct.

Reassessment Arrangements

Once your feedback on Moodle is visible it is important that you read it to make sure you understand it. If you have any questions, please contact your lecturer or Programme Leader who will help you.

We will contact you regarding support sessions, so you be supported during your resubmission. The resubmission deadlines will be published after the results have been published by the University.

Problems Completing an Assessment

You may be in a position where you cannot submit your coursework or take an exam due to circumstances that are:

- Unforeseeable - in that you could have no prior knowledge of the event concerned, and
- Unpreventable - in that you could do nothing reasonably in your power to prevent such an event, and
- Expected to have a serious impact on performance.

More information on support available to you can be found via the [Mitigating Circumstances webpages](#) (UEL login required) and the [Students' Union](#)

Online System Failures

If you experience a problem submitting your work online, you should notify your lecturer/tutor by email immediately.

Deadlines are not extended unless there are significant systems problems. If UEL finds that the issue with the system was significant, you will receive an email notifying you of the issue and that you have been given a 24-hour extension. **If you don't receive any email that specifically states you have been given an extension, then the original deadline has not been changed.**

Best advice: Don't wait until the last minute to submit your assessments electronically.

More information

- [A guide to submitting your work through **Turnitin** \(UEL login required\)](#)
- [A guide to viewing and understanding the similarity report in Turnitin \(UEL login required\)](#)
- [**Assessment & Feedback Policy**](#)

Referencing

As a student you will be taught how to write correctly referenced essays. UEL's standard **Harvard referencing** system is from Cite Them Right (UEL login required). Cite them Right is the standard Harvard referencing style at UEL for all Schools, however professional body requirements will take precedence for instance the School of Psychology which uses the APA system.

- [MyFeedback – submitting your draft for advice on writing and referencing. \(UEL login required\)](#)
- [Academic skills drop-in sessions \(Academic Tutoring\). \(UEL login required\)](#)
- [Library guide on citation and referencing \(UEL login required\)](#)
- [Video guide to Getting Started on Zotero \(UEL login required\)](#)
- [Zotero Student Written Guide](#)
- [Student Handbook page on Academic Misconduct and Plagiarism \(UEL login required\)](#)
- MyFeedback – submitting your draft for advice on writing and referencing. (UEL login required)
- Academic skills drop-in sessions (Academic Tutoring). (UEL login required)

- Advice on academic writing and statistics (Academic Tutoring) (UEL login required)

Reading and Resources

Core:

Mankiw, N. G., Taylor, P. M. and Ashwin, A. (2019). Business Economics. 3rd edn. Hampshire: Cengage Learning

Other Resources and Forms:

Begg, D., Vernasca, G., Fischer, S., and Dornbusch, R. (2014). Economics. 11th edn. Berkshire: McGraw-Hill Education

Sloman, J. and D. Garratt. (2016). Essentials of Economics. London: Pearson.

Barr, N. (2012). Economics of the Welfare State. 5th edn. Oxford: Oxford University Press

Referencing Skills:
Cite Them Right Online
UEL - Referencing Information

Return of Work and Feedback

Feedback is crucial for your learning, and it is an important part of the academic cycle. It tells you what the strengths are of your work, what its weaknesses are and how it can be improved.

Why is Feedback Important?

Feedback is the most effective way to:

- Help you understand how to succeed in your assessments;
- Help you produce better work for the future;
- Signpost you to other resources for assistance.

If you pay attention to feedback, particularly where the same comment is made in several modules, you can use the information to improve.

Where do I get Feedback?

- When a tutor comments on your answers in seminars/lectures/workshops
- General comment on assessment performance in lectures and seminars
- General comment on questions prepared for seminars
- When another student makes comments on your presentation
- When you produce practice questions for a tutor who gives comments
- When you receive written comments on your work submitted either as coursework or exam
- When you look at general feedback on module performance on UEL Direct.
- When you see your Academic Adviser with all your assessment feedback for general advice. You should always do this after each assessment period.

Formal results are ONLY available in UEL Direct and will be published within 8 working days of the Board, where results are formally confirmed. Any other results are provisional / indicative but not approved.

You will receive feedback throughout your this module through the following methods:

- one-to-one or individualised (*i.e. tutorials, conversations with supervisors, or individualised comments on assignments*)
- generic feedback (*i.e. use of rubrics, 'Quickmarks' in Turnitin or standardised forms*)
- informal feedback (*i.e. through in-class discussions or online forums*)
- self-evaluation (*i.e. online checklists or reflective submissions*)

Feedback and students' marks should be provided within 15 working days of the due date for summative work (*i.e. work that counts towards the final course grade*) and formative work (*i.e. work that is developmental and designed to help you improve*).

Whilst feedback will be given on draft/formative work, it shouldn't be assumed that every aspect will be identified.

Student Feedback on Your Experience

UEL values student feedback and we take action based on the feedback we receive.

Key Links

- [Academic Appeals](#)
- [Academic Integrity](#)
- [Access and Participation Plan](#)
- [Accreditation of Experiential Learning](#)
- [Assessment and Feedback Policy](#)
- [Bus Timetable](#)
- [Complaints procedure \(UEL login required\)](#)
- [Wellbeing Support \(UEL login required\)](#)
- [Disability support](#)
- [Attendance and Engagement Policy](#)
- [Procedure for problems completing an assessment \(UEL login required\)](#)
- [IT Support \(UEL login required\)](#)
- [Library Archives and Learning Services \(UEL login required\)](#)
- [Manual of General Regulations](#)
- [Mentoring \(UEL login required\)](#)
- [Office for Institutional Equity \(UEL login required\)](#)
- [Referencing guidelines \(UEL login required\)](#)
- [Student Engagement, Retention and Success \(UEL login required\)](#)
- [Student Protection Plan](#)
- [Suitability Procedure](#)
- [Track My Future](#)